

Green & Social Claims Scan - methodology note

This document explains the assessment logic used by the scan. It is designed as a claim-governance and compliance triage tool. It is not legal advice, does not establish a legal violation, and does not make a definitive greenwashing or social-washing finding.

1. Aim and scope

The scan reviews public websites and claim-related documents to identify risk signals in green and social claims. It distinguishes between client-facing or consumer-facing communication, investor/stakeholder reporting, and policy/internal governance documents. Client-facing green claims receive stronger EmpCo relevance; reports and policies are mainly treated as evidence, governance and consistency sources unless their wording is also used externally in commercial communication.

2. Main legal and standards lenses

Lens	Use in the scan	Weighting logic
Directive (EU) 2024/825 / EmpCo	Used for consumer-facing environmental claims, including generic environmental claims, climate-neutrality/offsetting claims, sustainability labels, comparative claims and future environmental performance claims.	Direct risk signals under EmpCo are weighted more strongly than broad sustainability expectations.
Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 / EU Forced Labour Regulation	Used for product, supplier, import/export, traceability, forced-labour-free and modern-slavery wording.	Direct forced-labour/product-market compliance signals are escalated as higher-priority social red flags.
OECD Guidelines, UNGP, UNGC, CSRD/ESRS	Used as supporting responsible-business and reporting frameworks for due diligence, stakeholder impacts, substantiation and governance.	Important context, but generally less heavily weighted than clear EmpCo or Forced Labour Regulation signals.

3. Score calculation

The tool calculates a green risk score and a social risk score. The global score combines both, with an additional audience adjustment where the reviewed material is client-facing. Each score uses four drivers:

Driver	Weight	Meaning
Claim wording risk	30%	Broad, generic, absolute, prominent or sensitive claim wording.
Substantiation / evidence gap	30%	Missing scope, methodology, KPIs, verification, limitations, traceability, grievance, remedy or approval evidence.
External contradictory context	25%	External stakeholder, regulator, media, NGO, legal or civil-society signals that may contradict the claim area. Company-owned documents are excluded from the external-source section.
Sector exposure	15%	Baseline sensitivity because some sectors are structurally more exposed to greenwashing or social-washing allegations. Sector exposure cannot by itself create a High-risk result.

4. Audience/channel classification

The scan separates sources into: (1) client-facing websites and commercial documents such as homepages, product pages, brochures, folders, campaign pages and marketing pages; (2) investor/stakeholder reporting such as annual reports, sustainability reports, ESG reports and integrated reports; and (3) policy/internal governance documents such as supplier codes, human-rights policies, procedures and due-diligence statements. This distinction matters because a claim that is acceptable as background evidence in a report may still be too broad for a consumer-facing page.

5. External public-source signals

The external-source section is deliberately limited to sources external to the company. Company-owned websites, reports, policies, statements and supplier documents are not shown as external public-source signals. They may still be used as reviewed documents or evidence sources. External signals are screening inputs only and must be manually verified for accuracy, relevance, date and source quality.

6. Red flags

The Red Flags section highlights the most important issues for review. It includes explicit potential regulatory red flags where high-sensitivity claim wording appears to fall directly under the EmpCo lens or the EU Forced Labour Regulation lens. A red flag is not a legal finding; it means that the claim should be escalated for substantiation, communications, compliance and legal review before external use.

7. Sector exposure

Sector exposure captures structural sensitivity. Retail, fast fashion, food, agriculture, commodities, transport, energy, financial services, telecoms and outsourced-services sectors may have elevated exposure because of complex supply chains, consumer-facing claims, emissions profiles, labour conditions, vulnerable stakeholders or product-market claims. The score uses sector exposure only as a baseline driver; High risk should also require problematic wording, an evidence gap or relevant external contradiction.

8. Limitations and disclaimer

This scan is an indicative first-pass assessment based on available website text, selected related domains and configured search providers. It may miss content behind cookies, scripts, paywalls, PDFs, images or crawler blocks. It does not replace legal analysis, human due diligence, document review or claim substantiation. The tool does not determine that a company has violated EmpCo, the EU Forced Labour Regulation or any other legal framework. Results should be verified by legal, compliance and subject-matter experts before external use.